MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer moving into DevOps and platform engineering, with hands-on ownership of GitLab CI, ephemeral Kubernetes environments, infrastructure automation and observability, and experience owning GitLab CI pipelines and building Kubernetes-based test environments for three product teams. Improved pipeline speed and CI runner costs through profiling and automation. Personal infrastructure projects include Terraform, k3s, GitOps and monitoring.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and GitOps: Kubernetes (namespace-level experience), Helm, Terraform (personal project), Argo CD, k3s, Ansible (basic)
Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki
Cloud and networking: AWS: EC2 and S3 (learning/basic personal use), Hetzner VPS, Traefik ingress, TLS certificate management: cert-manager
Languages and systems: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Linux, Git, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer, Test Infrastructure | Odrava Health Software | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams of approximately 25 developers, covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end tests, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30% by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests.
- Built merge-request environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster; GitLab CI deploys the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, allowing QA and product teams to review features before merge. Environments are automatically destroyed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Write Helm charts with namespace-level access; the platform team operates the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests. Built Grafana dashboards from CI results to help teams identify flaky tests; the flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tools to seed test data into PostgreSQL, and documented how CI works for internal onboarding.
- Documented how CI works for internal onboarding; the guide is used by new team members.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications manually and with automation across client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins jobs for nightly runs. Previously, a full regression took two people three days.
- Rewrote a small part of the API tests in Python as practice.

Customer Support Specialist, 2nd Line | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

PERSONAL PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a personal Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible (basic) for configuration.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | Studying; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish: Native | English: C1 | German: A2